MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | QA Automation Engineer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience and recent focus on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and has built short-lived Kubernetes test environments deployed through Helm, with experience improving pipeline performance—including reducing average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes—maintaining automated test infrastructure and supporting teams with clear internal documentation; seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)

Technical Toolkit

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level work and k3s homelab), Terraform (personal project), Argo CD
Monitoring and systems: Linux, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, Git
Programming and testing: Python, Bash, SQL, Java (test code), pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams of approximately 25 developers, covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing; Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage.
- Built merge-request test environments using Docker Compose and later Helm charts deployed to a shared Kubernetes cluster; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to under 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed test data in PostgreSQL; Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, which is used in onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal project | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.

- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Set up short-lived environments for each merge request, with the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Configured automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams can review features and run end-to-end tests before merge.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by approximately 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Helped teams identify test failures to address; the flaky test rate fell from 7% to under 1%.

Education & Training

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027, not yet passed